

“A **few old men** [had] **swords, a flintlock,** and half a dozen American **carbines.**”

US STATE DEPARTMENT DIRECTOR OF INTELLIGENCE ROGER HILSMAN, 1963

» AFTER

By the beginning of 1964, the Strategic Hamlets Program was in chaos.

FALL AND RISE

Following **Diem's assassination**, the program was abandoned. In 1967, pacification policies were revived by Civil Operations and Revolutionary Development Support (**CORDS**).

SPY REVELATIONS

After the Vietnam War ended, it was revealed that Nhu's chief lieutenant, Colonel Pham Ngoc Thao, was a communist agent. He had **sabotaged the Strategic Hamlets Program** by deliberately implementing it so quickly that it drove the alienated villagers into the camp of the Viet Cong.